Writing Course Redesign

Team Consultation — January 2026

📚 Kennisbasis 2.2 — Productive Skills

Core Concept: The starting teacher produces various forms of language output in the target language at an average C2 level of the CEFR. This concerns:

2.2.1 Clear and coherent speaking and writing in the target language appropriate to the **communicative purpose**, **target audience**, and **context**

2.2.2 Deploying **productive strategies**, including:

- Speaking and writing about **familiar and unfamiliar topics**
- Deploying appropriate **writing and speaking strategies** to improve the quality of both informal and formal production
- Deploying **conventions appropriate to the genre** concerned
- Demonstrating **consistent and accurate grammatical control**, including in complex language forms. Errors are virtually absent and relate only to rarely used forms.

📋 Learning Outcomes (All Courses)

#	Writing 1 (B1/B2)	Writing 2 (B2/C1)	Writing 3 (C1/C2)
1	Can **author** texts on familiar and unfamiliar topics **considering** communicative purpose, audience, and genre conventions	Can **author** texts **consciously adapting to** communicative purpose, audience, and genre conventions	Can **author** texts on familiar and unfamiliar topics **strategically adapting to** communicative purpose, audience, and genre conventions
2	Can **integrate sources** using APA referencing	Can demonstrate **stylistic control and diction** appropriate to genre	Can **integrate sources** using APA referencing
3	Can **apply and justify** writing strategies appropriate to the text	Can **consciously apply and justify** writing strategies appropriate to the text	Can **strategically apply and justify** writing strategies appropriate to complex tasks
4	Can write at **CEFR level B1/B2**	Can write at **CEFR level B2/C1**	Can write at **CEFR level C1/C2**

Note progression in Outcome 3: "apply" → "consciously apply" → "strategically apply"

✍️ Writing 1 — Timed Test

Timed Test — 60 minutes, supervised

Part A: Familiar Genre (15–20 min)

Professional communication in a known context. Students select one prompt from options such as:

- **Administrative email:** Respond to a parent inquiry about a student's progress or classroom policy
- **Colleague memo:** Inform team members about a schedule change or upcoming event
- **Professional request:** Email to administration requesting resources or proposing a minor change

Genre is familiar from teacher training; tests ability to produce appropriate register and tone under time pressure.

Part B: Unfamiliar Topic with Sources (40 min)

Expository paragraph on a provided topic using 1–2 given sources.

- Must include: 1 direct quote (grammatically integrated) + 1 paraphrase
- APA in-text citations required
- Topic requires engaging with source material (cannot answer from prior knowledge alone)

Rubric: Timed Test (3 criteria)

Criterion	Validates	What It Captures
Source Integration	Outcome 2	Quotes grammatically integrated, paraphrases accurate, APA formatting correct
Communicative Effectiveness	Outcome 1 (partial)	Does the text achieve its purpose for the intended audience?
Language Level	Outcome 4	Vocabulary range, grammatical accuracy, fluency at B1/B2

✍️ Writing 1 — Take-Home + Presentation + Q&A

Take-Home Assignment

Article for Semi-Formal Teacher Journal

A personal, argumentative piece written for a professional audience of fellow teachers. Students take a stance on a topic relevant to education and support it with evidence and reasoning.

- **Audience:** Fellow teachers (not academic examiners)
- **Tone:** Professional but personal; voice and perspective encouraged
- **Structure:** More freedom than traditional expository essay; can use subheadings, anecdotes, rhetorical questions
- **Sources:** Must integrate at least 2 sources using APA

⚡ **Admissibility Check (Go/No-Go before Presentation + Q&A)**

- **Formatting:** Document properly formatted
- **Language level:** Passes B2 "gut check" (no glaring errors)
- **APA reference list:** Present for sources used

Presentation + Q&A — 12.5 + 12.5 + 5 buffer = 30 min

Student presents their take-home article, explaining their choices. Followed by examiner questions probing authorship, process, and decision-making.

Presentation Elements (12.5 min)

Students address these elements (structured conversation, not rigid order):

1. **Communicative Purpose:** What is the article trying to do? Who is the audience? How does the text achieve its purpose?
2. **Writing Process:** Overall approach, preparation, tools used
3. **Genre Conventions — Content:** Source selection (why these, why not others), quote vs. paraphrase choices with examples
4. **Genre Conventions — Structure:** Topic sentence choices, argument selection, organizational decisions
5. **Detailed Writing Strategies:** Specific strategies used (using terminology), concrete examples from text, how strategies serve genre conventions

Rubric: Presentation + Q&A (2 criteria)

Criterion	Validates	What It Captures
Genre Awareness	Outcome 1	Can articulate communicative purpose, target audience (teachers), and genre conventions (content + structure)
Strategy Application	Outcome 3	Can explain high-level writing process and name specific strategies with examples from their text

Authorship is not a separate criterion — if students can articulate genre awareness and strategies, they've demonstrated authorship. The format itself validates it.

📊 Writing 2 & 3 — Assessment Overview

Course	Timed Test	Take-Home	Presentation + Q&A
Writing 2 (B2/C1)	**None** Language validated via W1 and W3	**Creative mimicry piece** No APA required	Heavy focus on genre awareness, diction choices, writing strategies. *Higher bar for articulation since no timed test.*
Writing 3 (C1/C2)	**90 minutes** 3 paragraphs, 3 sources, C1/C2 complexity	**Choice:** Proposal OR Creative piece (Murderless Mystery / Personal Essay)	4-criteria framework; outcomes general enough to apply to both proposal and creative options

Concentric change: *W2 is no longer concentric (passing W2 does not grant W1 exemption). W3 remains concentric (passing W3 grants exemptions for W1 & W2).*